AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Business Studies

BUC111
Business Communication 1

MTA Examination / Version: C
2024-2025 / Spring

10-April-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 5 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 1.5 hours

AOU EXAM PAPER

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED OFF" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the exa
8- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
9- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Polic

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
rt I	10	20 minutes	30		
rt II	6	10 minutes	18		
rt III	1	10 minutes	15		
t IV	1	20 minutes	15		
t V	1	30 minutes	22		
al	19	90 minutes	100		

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Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (30 marks)

1. Which of the following is a benefit of cultural diversity in teams?
   a) Reduced need for team communication
   b) Increased innovation and creativity
   c) More uniform thinking
   d) Avoiding differences in opinion
2. Which of the following is an example of how technology improves business communication accessibility?
   a) Using AI to automatically generate replies to customer queries
   b) Limiting communication tools to office hours
   c) Requiring face-to-face meetings for urgent matters
   d) Keeping communication channels private and unrecorded
3. Which of the following is a characteristic of the social communication model?
   a) Static messaging with little feedback
   b) High levels of control over the message
   c) Collaborative discussions with active audience participation
   d) Focus solely on written communication
4. In the conventional communication model, the sender's primary role is to:
   a) Provide feedback
   b) Decode the message
   c) Encode and transmit the message
   d) Listen actively
5. Which of the following represents a violation of intellectual property ethics?
   a) Quoting a source with proper citation
   b) Using a colleague's ideas without their permission
   c) Developing original content for a presentation
   d) Sharing open-source software within the team
6. Which of the following is a challenge of professional communication in a digital, social, and mobile world?
   a) Maintaining face-to-face communication
   b) Managing information overload
   c) Limiting access to communication tools
   d) Enhancing manual processes
7. Ethical communication in a digital environment involves:
   a) Being transparent and truthful
   b) Disguising one's identity
   c) Using informal language
   d) Ignoring privacy concerns
8. The _____ stage of team development involves the team members adjusting to each other and resolving conflicts.
   a) Forming
   b) Storming
   c) Norming
   d) Performing
9. Which of the following is a key factor in successful collaboration?
   a) Working in isolation

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b) Clear roles and responsibilities
c) Avoiding conflict at all costs
d) Unclear goals and objectives

10. To avoid stereotyping, it is important to:
a) Make assumptions based on cultural norms
b) Treat individuals as representatives of their culture
c) Avoid generalizations about groups of people
d) Use humor to break cultural barriers

Part II: Fill in the blanks: Use appropriate words from the box to fill in the blanks. **(18 marks)**

title – project – supportive – respect – feedback – digital

1. Business etiquette involves demonstrating _____ and professionalism in workplace interactions.
2. _____ teams are formed for a specific purpose and are disbanded after achieving their goals.
3. Active listening involves giving the speaker your full attention and providing _____ to show understanding and engagement.
4. Teams benefit from having a _____ leader who focuses on guiding rather than controlling the group.
5. When addressing someone in a professional setting, it is important to use their appropriate _____, such as Mr., Ms., or Dr.
6. In the social communication model, _____ platforms play a significant role in facilitating two-way communication.

Part III: What are the five areas in which business etiquette is important for professional communication? **(15 marks)**

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------
4. ----------
5. ----------

Part IV: List and briefly explain the **three steps in the writing process** for effective business communication. **(15 marks)**

1. ----------

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2. ----------

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3. ----------

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Part IV - Analyzing Communication Effectiveness: Read the case and the email below, then answer the questions that follow in a PARAGRAPH. (22 marks)

Background: A customer has sent an inquiry to a salesperson (John) asking for more information about a specific product. The following is the salesperson's response via email to the customer to address the inquiry.

Subject: Product Inquiry

Dear Customer,

Thank you for your inquiry. I received your email asking about our product, but I'm not sure what exactly you're asking. We have a lot of different products, so it's hard to know which one you need.

Please check our website for more details, and feel free to contact us if you want something specific. I'm sure you'll find what you need there.

Looking forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,
John

Questions:

1. What should be the purpose of this email?
2. Is the email the most appropriate channel in this case? Why or why not?
3. What elements make the message ineffective? Justify your answer by giving three examples from the email.
4. What should the writer do to make the message effective? Give at least 3 tips for improvement.

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